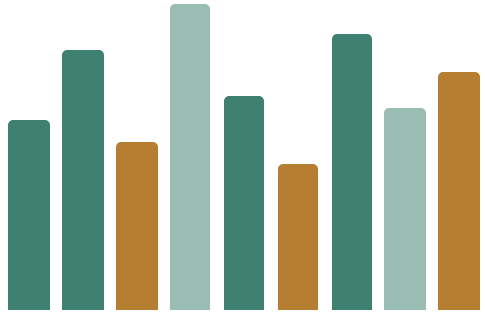
POC KICK-OFF 30 MD · 6 WEEKS

More books in every basket

Can personal recommendations grow your sales? In six weeks we will show you, on your own data.

PREPARED BY
Petr Dvořáček
Solution lead · AI Consultant / Architect

FOR
Online Book Shop · kick-off meeting



Recommendations grow sales through three levers

1

Discover

A reader finds the next book instead of a dead end

more clicks

2

Buy

More visits end with a purchase

higher conversion

3

Add one more

The next book in the series lands in the basket

bigger orders

Books suit this well: people read in series and follow favourite authors.

Your data is enough to start. To prove sales, we need your orders

What we have

- ✓ **1.1 M** ratings from **105 k** readers
- ✓ **270 k** books with titles and covers

56 %

of readers rated just one book. Most customers are new or occasional, so recommendations must work without a history.

What we need from you

- → Order history with dates and prices
- → Product page views
- → Genres and stock from your catalogue

Data detail and data issues: appendix A1, A14

A simple idea already beats your bestseller list

"Readers who liked this also enjoyed…"

The Hobbit → **The Two Towers** **The Return of the King** **The Silmarillion**

Books go together when the **same readers** enjoy both. No genre data needed, and every tip can say why.

Tested on your data

Bestseller list	**8 %**
Our model	**19 %**

of readers got a pick they actually read. **2.4× more often**, using 77 % of the catalogue instead of ~35 bestsellers.

Five approaches compared: appendix A2–A4

Four steps from your data to recommendations

1
Your data
Orders, catalogue, ratings

→

2
Clean & connect
Merge editions, remove errors

→

3
Learn
Which books go together

→

4
Recommend
Book page · “For you” · newsletter

Runs on a secure copy of your data. Nothing changes in your live shop.

In six weeks you will know if recommendations can grow your sales

The PoC succeeds when

- ✓ **Better picks:** beats your bestseller list on real purchases by 20 %+
- ✓ **Your experts agree:** 7 in 10 lists pass their blind test
- ✓ **Worth it:** expected extra revenue clearly exceeds the cost

Optional: a first real sales signal from a newsletter A/B test (slide 10).

Focus

Book page tips + personal picks, with a fallback for new visitors

Not yet

Live website integration and a website A/B test. They come after a “go”.

Six weeks, three moments where you decide

WEEK 1

Data

Access, check quality

◆ Is the data good enough?

WEEKS 2–4

Build & test

Models tested on your purchases

◆ Does it beat bestsellers?

WEEK 5

Your experts

Blind test, demo

WEEK 6

Decide

Business case, production plan

◆ Go live?

If the data is not good enough, we change course in week 1, not week 6.

One team: four specialists from us, five roles on your side

DataSentics

Solution lead me	Your contact, scope, decisions
Data Scientist	Builds and tests the models
Data Engineer	Gets your data ready
ML Engineer	Demo and production plan

Your side

Sponsor	Decides at the three gates · ~2 h/week
Product owner	Day-to-day priorities · ½ day/week
Data owner	Data access · mainly week 1
2 book experts	Judge the picks · weeks 1 and 5
Web lead + DPO	Integration, GDPR · as needed

Roles, MD split and responsibilities: appendix A10

You see progress every week, and every result is checked four ways

How we run it

- ✓ **Every Friday:** demo + 30-min decision meeting
- ✓ **Budget in sight:** days used vs. plan, weekly
- ✓ **One owner** for every deliverable
- ✓ **Changes** only by joint decision

How we check it makes sense

1. **Data** matches your own reports
2. **Model** predicts real past purchases better than bestsellers
3. **Your experts** judge the lists in a blind test
4. **Customers** vote with clicks and purchases in an A/B test

Validation and metrics in detail: appendix A5, A12

After a “go”: recommendations run every day and measure their own revenue

Your systems
Shop, orders, catalogue, stock

→

Nightly update
Learns from yesterday’s sales

→

Recommendation service
Instant, follows your rules: in stock, not yet bought

→

Web · app · newsletter
Revenue measured daily

Then, step by step: `1 Website A/B test` `2 Your business rules` `3 New titles via descriptions` `4 Basket & newsletter` `5 Live, in-session picks`

Runs itself: automatic nightly updates and alerts, a monthly quality review by a named owner.

Seven questions that shape the PoC

1. How many years of **orders** do you keep, with dates and prices?
2. What share of customers **log in**?
3. Which **shop platform** do you use, and who would connect it?
4. Does customer **consent** cover personalisation?
5. What **sales uplift** would make this worth it for you?
6. Which **rules** must picks follow: own titles, publisher deals, age?
7. How **fresh** is this export, and how often can you send data?

Our proposal

Do you send a newsletter, with consent?

Then we can add a small A/B test to the PoC: half get personal picks, half get bestsellers. You see real clicks and purchases **within the six weeks**.

Full question list and risks: appendix A11

Five decisions today, and we start tomorrow

Today we agree

1. What success means (slide 05)
2. Start with the book page
3. Your people for the five roles (slide 07)
4. Where your data is processed
5. Friday meeting slot

This week

Day 1	We send the data request and data agreement
Days 2–3	Data arrives in a secure workspace
Week 1	Workshop with your book experts
Friday	**First decision: is the data good enough?**

→ TRY IT YOURSELF

Now see it work on real data

The prototype shows your shop with the recommendation engine switched on, built on your data. Open a book page, switch between a loyal reader and a new visitor, and compare with the bestseller list.

Open the prototype →